Example Homework 1- The Great Dilemma

The moral machine exercise of considering who I was saving during possible accidents in a driverless car were significantly different than my preconceived views I thought I had going into the exercise and what the measures ended up showing.

My most saved character was the male doctor, and the most killed character was the female. This not only was counted on my kill/save measure but also on the gender saved preferences. This was interesting to me as I did not necessarily look at whom I was saving I was just counting heads and the least about injured/ killed was the option I chose. However, my answers based on age, social class, or fitness scale did not align anywhere near compared to that of others as it was not the main factor, I was using to make any of my decisions. If either option resulted in the same number of casualties, I left the car on the path intended.

One positive of automated cars is the driving assist that is currently in many of the newer cars, while this can help with setting the cruise control for extended car rides, I appreciate the factor for having a second set of eyes, likely braking before I even get the chance to notice the change in taillights from the driver in front of me. One of the negatives about automation in cars is the loss of driving experience one acquires only by being behind the wheel. Roads without markings that can be found in less than ordinary terrain require driving skills to navigate, ones that automated cars do not have (DeRose). Drivers that have become dependent on driverless cars or spent very little time driving prior to having an automated car may not be equipped to handle situations safely.

As I consider how I came to choosing my morals in this situation I can relate to the Rights Approach as each person has the right to live and are at equal opportunity to have safety in their mode of transportation (Week 1 Letaw & Safonte). Each life holds a value, and it is not up to me at time of impact to make a decision who is the better person to save, if I had that much time to consider details of people I had enough time to stop the car. The Utilitarian approach is also reasonable to consider as the production and programming of the car should be best suited to serve the most amount of people.

DeRose, G., Ramsey, A., Dombecki, J., Paul, N., & Chung, C. (2023). Autonomously Steering Vehicles along Unmarked Roads Using Low-Cost Sensing and Computational Systems. *Vehicles*, *5*(4), 1400–1422. https://doi.org/10.3390/vehicles5040077

Letaw,Larissa&,Safonte,Danielle(n.d.). https://canvas.oregonstate.edu/courses/1967062/pages/week-1-learn-ethics-and-society?module_item_id=24455844

Moral machine. (n.d.). Moral Machine. https://www.moralmachine.net/